# From the Chairman's Desk

Volume 2, Issue 2, June 2026

***Halfway Through 2026: Accelerating Sustainable Impact Through Partnership***

Dear Friends and Partners,

Welcome to the second issue of our newsletter for the year.

As we reflect on the months behind us, I am filled with gratitude for the remarkable progress we continue to make together. Every milestone we celebrate represents the collective commitment of our staff, Board, volunteers, partners, donors, and supporters who believe in our mission and work tirelessly to make a lasting difference.

This edition highlights not only the achievements we have recorded but also the lives transformed through our programmes. Whether it is expanding access to education, improving livelihoods through monthly support, or extending hope to vulnerable children and families, each story reminds us that sustainable change is possible when people unite around a shared purpose.

While we celebrate these accomplishments, we also recognise that much work remains. The challenges facing our communities continue to evolve, requiring innovation, collaboration, and unwavering determination. We remain committed to strengthening our programmes, building and formalising strategic partnerships, and ensuring that every intervention delivers measurable and lasting impact.

On behalf of SOOWER Foundation, I extend our sincere appreciation to everyone who has journeyed with us. Your trust, generosity, and partnership continue to inspire us to aim higher and serve better. Together, we are not only responding to today's needs but also investing in a future where every individual has the opportunity to thrive.

As you read through this edition, I hope you will celebrate our shared achievements and be encouraged by the progress we are making. We look forward to your continued partnership as we accelerate our efforts to create lasting and meaningful change.

Thank you for being an integral part of our journey.

Warm regards,

**Engr. Jonathan Agwunobi**
Chairman & Co-Founder, SOOWER Foundation

# Mother's Day Outreach: Sharing Hope at Don Guanella Rehabilitation Centre

As part of the Catholic Mothering Sunday celebrations, SOOWER Foundation had the privilege of partnering with the Catholic Women Organisation (CWO) of Holy Trinity Catholic Church, Maitama, Abuja, led by the President, Lady Tosan Chukwueke, to visit the Don Guanella Rehabilitation Centre – a remarkable home dedicated to caring for children with special needs on April 17, 2026.

The women went along with food items for the home, and SOOWER Foundation donated some money, which was presented to the Reverend Father (Dr Nwagbaso Ifeanyichukwu Isaac) in charge of the home. This visit was an opportunity to connect, listen, and engage in meaningful conversations about the Centre's future and how collaborative partnerships can help strengthen its capacity to provide quality care and expand its impact.

The day served as a powerful reminder that genuine compassion is expressed not only through giving but also through presence, partnership, and shared purpose. At SOOWER Foundation, we remain committed to building relationships that uplift vulnerable people and create lasting, sustainable change. Together, we can continue to inspire hope and transform lives.





# Empowering Communities Through Skills and Opportunity

SOOWER Foundation partnered with one of its longest-standing partners, the Regy and Henry Amazing Grace Foundation (RHAGF), for a three-week Literacy, Vocational and Psychosocial Support Intervention in the Gazhimayi Community, Galadimawa, Abuja. Other partners on this programme include Daruwana Foundation, the National Commission for Mass Education (NMEC), NACTAL, NDLEA, Mental Health for Youth Initiative, and other private partners. The initiative equipped vulnerable members of the community with practical skills to improve their livelihoods and promote self-reliance.

Held from April 7–24, 2026, the programme brought together 371 beneficiaries, including widows, orphans, vulnerable women, unemployed youth, and other at-risk groups. Participants received practical training in tailoring, cosmetology, pastry and baking, shoe making, hairdressing, POS operations, and barbering, providing them with marketable skills to create sustainable sources of income.

A major milestone of the intervention was the establishment of a Skill Acquisition and Literacy Centre in the Gazhimayi community. Equipped with sewing machines, a baking oven, educational materials, and vocational tools, the centre will continue to provide opportunities for learning and skills development long after the training programme.








The programme also demonstrated the power of collaboration. Traditional leaders, including the District Head of Galadimawa, community leaders, government agencies, development partners, and private donors came together to support an initiative that strengthens livelihoods and builds community resilience. Their participation underscored a shared commitment to creating lasting opportunities for vulnerable populations.

For SOOWER Foundation, the intervention reflects our ongoing commitment to empowering widows and orphans through education, skills development, and strategic partnerships. By investing in people and creating pathways to economic independence, we are helping individuals build brighter futures while strengthening the communities they call home.

# Strengthening Our Foundations

## Advancing Organisational Compliance with the Federal Ministry of Women Affairs and Social Development








On June 18, 2026, SOOWER Foundation welcomed officials from the Federal Ministry of Women Affairs and Social Development to our office as part of our ongoing registration and compliance process with the Federal Government.

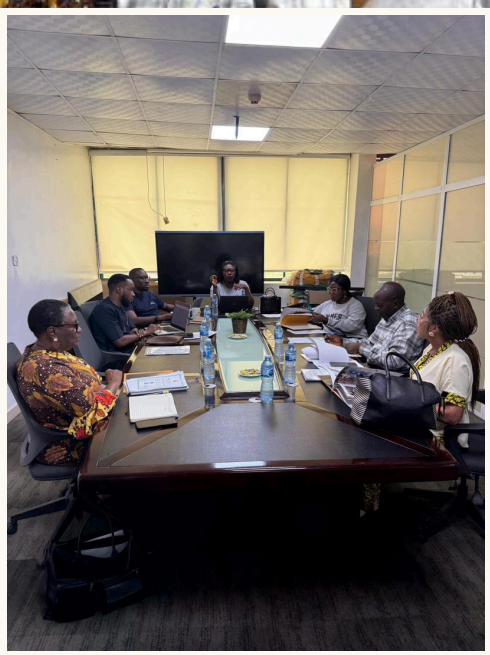
Following the submission of the required documentation, the Ministry's officials conducted an inspection of our operations and engaged with members of the SOOWER team to gain a deeper understanding of our governance structures, programmes, and organisational systems. The visit provided an opportunity to demonstrate our commitment to transparency, accountability, and effective service delivery for vulnerable individuals and communities.

This engagement marks an important step in strengthening our institutional framework and advancing our registration process. It also reinforces our commitment to maintaining the highest standards of governance while positioning SOOWER Foundation for stronger partnerships and greater impact.

# Strengthening Our Foundations

## Compliance Visit by the Federal Ministry of Humanitarian Affairs and Poverty Reduction





On June 25, 2026, SOOWER Foundation hosted officials from the Federal Ministry of Humanitarian Affairs and Poverty Reduction as part of the Foundation's registration and compliance process with the Federal Government.

During the visit, the officials reviewed our submitted documentation, inspected our operational processes, and interacted with members of the SOOWER team to gain insight into our governance systems, programmes, and organizational capacity. The engagement highlighted our dedication to accountability, sound institutional practices, and delivering sustainable interventions that improve the lives of vulnerable communities.

This visit represents another significant milestone in our journey toward full regulatory compliance. As we continue to strengthen our institutional systems, SOOWER Foundation remains committed to excellence in governance and to building trusted partnerships that enable us to expand our impact and serve communities more effectively.

# Standing With Widows on International Widows Day

On June 23, 2026, the world observed International Widows Day, a United Nations-designated day to recognise widows, raise awareness of the challenges they face, and advocate for their rights and well-being. This year's theme, "Justice, Dignity and Economic Power for Widows," highlighted the importance of sustainable livelihoods, cooperative finance, and equitable land inheritance rights.

International Widows Day is especially significant to SOOWER Foundation because supporting widows as they regain stability, restore their livelihoods, and rebuild their lives with dignity is central to our mission. To mark the occasion, our Executive Director, Prof. Imelda Udoh, shared a message (below) of encouragement with the 141 widows currently supported by the Foundation:

*"Today, we celebrate the strength, resilience, and courage of widows around the world. At SOOWER Widows & Missions Foundation, we recognise the invaluable contributions of widows to their families, communities, and society. We also acknowledge the challenges many widows face and reaffirm our commitment to supporting, empowering, and advocating for their well-being and dignity.*

*To all our dear widows, please know that you are valued, appreciated, and never alone. Your stories inspire us, your perseverance strengthens us, and your lives matter deeply. As we mark this special day, we pray that God continues to comfort, strengthen, and bless each of you with hope, peace, and renewed opportunities.*

*Happy World Widows Day!"*




At SOOWER Foundation, our commitment to widows extends far beyond a single day of recognition. Through livelihood support, economic empowerment, and community, we continue to walk alongside widows as they rebuild their lives with dignity, hope, and renewed purpose.

# Impact at a Glance

## SOOWER's Impact (April 2026 – June 2026)

| | |
|---|---|
| **38 beneficiaries trained** | Widows and orphans gained practical livelihood skills. |
| **141 widows supported** | Widows continued to receive encouragement and monthly support as part of SOOWER Foundation's mission of dignity, hope, and empowerment. |
| **31 missionaries supported** | Missionaries continued to receive encouragement and monthly support as part of SOOWER Foundation's mission of dignity, hope, and empowerment. |
| **2 federal compliance visits completed** | Engagements with federal ministries strengthened SOOWER Foundation's governance, accountability, and institutional readiness for expanded partnerships. |

# Join Us this Quarter

We invite you to partner with SOOWER Foundation in sustaining and expanding this work of hope. Your support enables us to continue providing monthly livelihood assistance, healthcare, education support, and welfare interventions for widows, missionaries, orphans, and displaced families.

You can be part of this impact by:

- **Donating** to support monthly stipends, education, healthcare, and emergency relief. Donations can be made to the following account:
  **Account Number:** 1307460869
  **Account Name:** SOOWER Widows & Missions Foundation
  **Bank Name:** Providus Bank.
- **Partnering** with us as an organization or faith-based institution.
- **Volunteering** your time, skills, or professional expertise.
- **Advocating** by sharing our mission and amplifying the voices of the vulnerable.
- **Praying** with and for the communities we serve.

Together, we can deepen our reach, strengthen lives, and ensure that compassion continues beyond the season into the year ahead.

For partnership and support, please connect with SOOWER Foundation through our official channels.


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**Soower Foundation**

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**SOOWER Widows and Missions Foundation**

*Perfectly positioned to lend a helping hand!*